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Satic GK

Classical and Folk Dances

Sangeet Natak Akademi recognised 8 classical dances of India named as Bhaatanatyam (Tamil Nadu), Kathak (Uttar Pradesh), Kathakali (Kerala), Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh), Manipuri (Manipur), Mohiniyattam (Kerala), Odissi (Odisha), Sattriya (Assam).

The Ministry of Culture recognised Chhau dance as 9th classical dance of India. The Medieval term of Dancing is "Raqs". The technique of classical dancing was codified by Bhaata in about the 5th century B.C. The national award for classical dance is called the Abhinandan Saroja Award.

Bharatanatyam

Bhaatanatyam expresses South Indian religious themes and spiritual ideas of Shaivism. It was formerly known as the Sadir Attam. Krishna Iyer first coined the term Bhaatanatyam for the Sadir dance. It was banned by the colonial British government in 1910. It is the first of India's traditional dances to be refashioned as a theatre art and to be exhibited widely both at home and abroad.

It evolved from ekahaya, where one dancer takes on many roles in a single performance. It emerged in the temples of South India, performed by Dardassis, thus also known as Dasiattam. Bhaatanatyam is traditionally performed to Carnatic music.

It consists of six portions: Alarippu (Invocation), Jathiswaram (Nritta part), Shabdham (Short compositions with word), Varnam (a story, that includes both Nritta and Nritya), Padam (Religious prayer, Bhajan, Keerthanam) and Tillana (Origin in the Tarana of Hindustani Music).

Bhaatanatyam poses are depicted on the gopurams of the Chidambaram temple (Tamil Nadu). A Bhaatanatyam artist uses Abhinaya (the Sanskrit word and it means 'taking towards') as a tool to convey ideas and evoke emotions among the audience members. Abhinaya can be classified into four types :

Satvika Abhinaya (expressing by evoking the state of mind of the character), Angika Abhinaya (expressing using body movements such as movement of hands,

legs and limbs) Vachika Abhinaya (expressing using medium of speech such as songs, music and dialogues), and Aharya Abhinaya (expressing using decorations such as costumes, jewelry and makeup).

The four Nattuvanars namely Ponaiyah, Vadivelu, Sivanandam and Chinnaiya, who are renowned as Tanjore Bandhu shaped up the modern day Bhaatanatyam.

Different styles of **Bhaatanatyam**, called Banis :-

Thanjavur Style : Kandappa Pillai one of the famous Nattuvanars (Guru /Teacher) of this style and a direct descendant of the Tanjore Quartette was trained by Kannuswami Pillai.

Pandanallur Style is attributed to the famous Minakshisundaam Pillai who was a direct descendant of the Tanjore Quartette.

Vazhavur style was created by Ramiah Pillai of Vazhuvoor town in Tamil Nadu.

Kalakshetra Style is credited to the disciple of Minakshisundaam Pillai and a renowned Bhaatanatyam exponent Rukmini Devi Arundale. Rukmini Devi founded the Kalakshetra Institute in Chennai making it a platform to promote Bhaatanatyam as an art form.

Melattur Style is credited to Mangudi Doirairaja Iyer. It is known for its soft footwork and emphasis on the sringaa rasa.

Famous Dancers : Kamala Naayan, Bala Saswati, C. V Chandrasekhar, Leela Samson, Mrinalini Sarabhai, Padma Subramanyam, Rukmini Devi, Sonal Mansingh, Yamini Krishnamurti, Lakshmana Swamy Alarmel Valli, Smrithi Krishnamuthy, Hema Malini, Mallika Sarabhai, Vasundhara Daswamy, Chitra Visweswaran, Vijayanthimala, Swati Tirunal etc.

Mohiniyattam

Mohiniyattam (Malayalam) is an Indian classical dance originated in the state of Kerala. Mohiniyattam literally means dance of the enchantress'. The dance is performed by women in honor of the Hindu God Vishnu in his incarnation as the enchantress Mohini. Kalyanikutty Amma is known as the 'Mother of Mohiniyattam'.

It emotes a play through dancing in which the song is customarily in Manipravala language.

It is lasya-style based on Nattya Shasta. It consists of 'Nritta' and 'Nritya' mentioned in 'Nattya Shastra'. It includes facial expressions and hand gestures.

The main percussion instrument used in the performance of Mohiniyattam dance is Edakka.

It consists of seven portions:

Chollettu, Jatisvaram, Varnam, Padam (song), Tillana, Shlokam (a hymn in praise), and Saptam (the Expressions (or Abhinaya)).

The techniques of Mohiniyattam consist of Adavus (steps) and Mudras (hand gestures).

Adavus is classified into four: Thaganams, Jaganams, Dhaganams, and Samishams. These adavus were codified by Kalamandalam Kalyanikutty Amma in 20th century CE.

Mudras are based on the book Hastalakshana deepika. There are a total of 24 mudras. Some are : Pataka, Katakam, Mushti, Kathari, etc.

Famous Dancers : Sunanda Nair Smitha Rajan, Gopika Varma, Jayaprabha Menon, Pallavi Krishnan and Vinitha Nedungadi, etc.

Kuchipudi

Kuchipudi (short form of 'Kuchelapuram' or 'Kuchilapuri') is India's classical dance originated in a village called Kuchelapuri in Andhra Pradesh. It was developed by Siddhendra Yogi.

Kuchipudi is accompanied by Carnatic music. It incorporates all three classical dance elements : Nritta (non-narrative and abstract dancing), Nritya, and Nattya. They combine dance, mime, and acting.

Daru is the main content of the music in Kuchipudi; it adapts Jaru style of singing in medium and quick tempos.

It is characterized by graceful, swaying body movements with no abrupt jerks or sudden leaps. It belongs to the lasya style (soft and suitable for female presentation) .

A Kuchipudi recital is usually concluded with taangam. Excerpts of Krishna-leela-taangini are sung with this

number. In this the dancer usually stands on a bass plate locking the feet in shakata/adanam paada and moves the plate rhythmically with great dexterity.

Famous dancers : Guru Smt. Vijaya Pasad, Dr Vempati Chinna Satyam, Kalpalathika, Raja and Radha Reddy Kaushalya Reddy Yamini Reddy Bhavana Reddy Aisha Patap Singh, Sreelakshmy Govardhanan, Smt. Vijayanthi Kashi, Haleem Khan, Pateeksha Kashi, Yamini Krishnamurthy, Arunima Kumar, Achuta Manasa, Shobha Naidu, Uma Rama Rao, Vedantam Satyanarayana Sarma, etc.

Manipuri

Manipuri is known for its Hindu Vaishnavism themes, and Radha - Krishna's love - inspired dance drama Rasleela. The predominant theme of Manipuri dance is Devotion and Love. Rabindranath Tagore is primarily credited with reviving and popularizing the Manipuri dance tradition in the early 20th century.

Two categories of Manipuri dance are Jagoi (reflects the Lasya item mentioned in Natty Shastra of Bharata) and Cholom (form of classical Tandava dance). The masculine aspect of Manipuri classical dance is known as Choloms.

The ethnic majority of Meitei people call Manipuri dance as 'Jagoi'.

Manipuri dance is introverted and restrained compared to most dances of India. In this dance the artist never established eye contact with the audience. The Manipuri classical style of singing is called 'Nat'.

Varieties of Manipuri forms of dance :

Manipuri dance has two traditions: one is the sankeertana (which is the devotional aspect) and the other is the Raasa.

Manipuri Sankitana was also inscribed in the Representative List of the UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity in 2013. It is practiced primarily by the Vaishnava community in Manipur (also in some parts of Tripura and Assam). It is performed to narrate the life and deeds of Lord Krishna. Instruments used are Cymbals (Kaataala) and Drums (Choloms).

Pung Cholom (meaning "bar of the drums") is the soul of Manipuri Sankitana music and classical Manipuri dance.

Dhol Cholom (Drum Dance or Dholak Cholom) is performed in the spring season known as 'Baisang' meaning Spring Festival of Holi.

Katal Cholam is a Tandava dance of cymbals. It is performed by the male dancers only.

'Ras Leela' refers to the 'Dance of Divine Love' that beautifully portrays the affection between Krishna - the eighth avatar of Lord Vishnu, and Radha - the consort of Lord Krishna. Its three types are Tal Rasak (followed by a clap), Danda Rasak (drums are pounded with two sticks while the dancers' position produces geometric shapes), Mandal Rasak (Lord Krishna in the centre surrounded by the Gopis).

Famous dancers : Hanjaba Guru Bipin Singha, Jhaveri Sisters (Nayana Jhaveri, Ranjana Jhaveri, Suverna Jhaveri, and Darshana Jhaveri), Nirmala Mehta, Savita Mehta, Yumlembam Gambhini Devi, Kalavati Devi etc.

Odissi

Odissi (Odisha) roots can be traced back to Natty Shastra. Its south-eastern style is known as the Odha Magadha. Archaeological evidence of this dance form dating back to the 2nd century B.C. is found in the caves of Udayagiri and Khandagiri near Bhubaneswar.

The Pakhawaj syllables are primarily used to conclude Odissi dance.

The performance repertoire includes invocation, nritya (pure dance), nritya (expressive dance), natya (dance drama) and moksha (dance climax connoting freedom of the soul and spiritual release).

Nritya and Abhinaya are the two most interesting attractions of Odissi. The foundation of Odissi dance lies in two fundamental postures : Chauka and Tribhanga.

Nritya : Dancers perform delicate physical movements to create ornamental movements.

Abhinaya : Dancers make facial expressions to explain a religious story or legend.

Famous dancers : Sonal Mansingh, Sanyukta Panigrahi, Jhelum Paranjape, Mayadhar Raut, Gangadhar Padhan, Ileana Citaristi, Leena Mohanty Chita Krishnamuti, Bijayini Satpathy Madhavi

Mudgal, Sanchita Bhattacharya, Sutapa Talukdar, Deba Pasad Das, Pankaj Chandra Das, Raghunath Dutta, etc.

Kathak

In Kathak dance (Uttar Pradesh) the term Kathak comes from the Sanskrit Vedic word Katha which means 'story' and Kathakar which means 'one who tells a story' or 'related to stories'. The story of Radha and Krishna is the major theme of Kathak. Hindustani Classical Music associated with this dance. The main Gharanas (houses) of Kathak, are located in Lucknow, Jaipur, Banaras and Chhattisgarh.

It was popularized under the rule of Mughals. The Golden age of this dance comes under the patronage of Wajid Ali Shah (last Nawab of Oudh). Erstwhile Princely state Awadh was primarily associated with Kathak. National institute of Kathak dance is located in New Delhi.

Natwari Nritya and Thumri music is associated with Kathak dance.

Three main sections of a Kathak dance are invocation and 'Nritya' and 'Nritya' mentioned in 'Natty Shastra'.

Nritya : Pure dance portrayed by the artist.

Nritya : Here the artist showcases a story or theme through gestures, expressions and slow body movements accompanied by vocal and instrumental music.

Facial expressions and sensuous gestures emotive during Kathak performances are mentioned in the book 'The Wrongs of Indian Womanhood' by Marcus B. Fuller published in 1900.

Famous dancers : Pandit Birju Mahapatra, Lachu Mahapatra, Shambhu Mahapatra, Shovna Naayan, Kumari Kamala, Sunanya Hazarilal Agarwal, Pandit Durgalal, Perana Shrimala, Rani Karna, Sitara Devi, Rupa Rani Das Bora, Roshan Kumari, Maya Rao, Kumudini Lakhia, Rohini Bhate, Pandit Munnalal Shukla, Uma Sharma, Sangeet Majumdar, Deepa Katha etc.

Kathakali

In Kathakali (Kerala) the term Kathakali is derived from Katha (Sanskrit) meaning 'story or conversation, or traditional story', and Kali (from art) meaning 'performance and art'.

The dance-drama art form called 'Krishnanattam' and Ramanattam based on Mahabharata and Ramayana are precursors of 'Kathakali'. Traditionally the stage presentation of this dance was immediately preceded by a practice session called *sarakali* and undertaken in the precincts of a temple. This dance took shape in Southern India in the seventeenth century under the patronage of the Prince of Karnataka.

Kathakali classical dance style manifests the element of Sky

It is a harmonious combination of 5 forms of fine art - Literature (Sahithyam), Music (Sangeetham), Painting (Chitham), Acting (Natyam) and Dance (Nritham). The dance form combines four aspects of abhinaya (Angika, Aharya, Vachika, Satvika) and the Nritta, Nritya and Natya.

The story Nalacharitham is written by "Unnai Vairier". It is the romantic story of unlimited love between Nala and Damayanthi. There are 24 Basic Mudras (hand gestures) and a total of 470 different symbols used in this dance.

Characters in this dance are broadly divided into satvika (noble characters like Krishna and Rama), rajasika (evil characters) and tamasika (beard characters). It follows the traditional sopana sangeet of Kerala.

In Kathakali emphasis is given more on 'Aharya Abhinaya', the use of costumes, ornaments and facial make-up.

A Kathakali performance begins with the "Kelikottu", calling the audience to attention followed by the "Thodayam". "Kelikottu" is the formal announcement of the Kathakali dance done in the evening when drums and cymbals are played for a while in the courtyard.

Then the musicians and drummers hold the stage with an exhibition of their skills in "Melappadam". The end of the performance is marked by a piece of pure dance called "Dhanasi". "Tianokku" is the debut on the stage of all characters other than the "Pacha" or "Minukku".

The five major Veshams in Kathakali are Kathi (Knife), Pacha (Green), Thaadi (Beard), Minukku (adiant) and Kari (Black).

Kalasams are pure dance sequences where the actor is at great liberty to express himself and display his skills.

The leaps, quick turns, jumps and the rhythmic co-ordination make kalasams, a joy to watch.

Famous dancers : Kalamandalam Gopi, Haripriya Namboodiri, Kalamandalam Krishna Pasad, Kottakal Sivaraman, Kalamandalam Ramankutty Nair, Kalamandalam Vasu Pisharody, Karungal Chathunni Panicker, Kalamandalam Krishnan Nair

Sattriya dance

Sattriya dance (Assam) originated in Satta, a monastery, as a part of the neo-Vaishnavite movement started by Srimanta Sankaradev in Assam, in the 15th Century. The songs composed by Sankaradeva are known as 'Borgeet'.

The Sattriya dance can be classified into two styles, namely 'Purashik Bhangi' i.e. Tandava or Masculine style and 'Stri Bhangi' i.e. Lasya or feminine style.

Chali, Jhumura and Nadu Bhangi are associated with Sattriya dance and Ankiya Nat is a subgenre consisting of one-act plays of Sattriya.

Pat Silk saree is the most popular kind of saree used in this dance, which represents the locality through its various colorful motifs and designs.

The basic dance unit and exercise of a Sattriya is called a Mati Akhara. There are 64 Mati Akharas and they may be further sub-divided into eight main types: Oa, Saata, Jhalak, Sitika, Pak, Jap, Lon and Khar

Sattriya was recognised in 2000 as a Classical Dance by Sangeet Natak Akademi.

Famous dancers : Gunakanta Dutta Barbayan, Manik Barbayan, Jogen Dutta Bayan, Anita Sarma, Sapdi Saikia, Haricharan Bhuyan Borbayan, Ramkrishna Talukdar, Ranjumon Saikia, etc.

Chhau Dance

Chhau Dance is a folk dance of West Bengal, Jharkhand and Odisha with martial traditions. It is found in three styles: Purulia Chhau (performed during sun festival in West Bengal), Seraikella Chhau (Jharkhand), Mayurbhanj Chhau (Odisha). The Ministry of Culture recognised it as 9th classical dance of India.

The fundamental vocabulary of Chhau

dance constitutes mock combat techniques, stylised gaits of birds and animals and movements modelled on the chores of village housewives and mostly performed by male dancers in eastern India.

Dancers enacted stories from the Hindu epics the Ramayana and the Mahabharata, the Puranas and other Indian literature. It is performed with religious themes found in Shaivism, Shaktism and Vaishnavism.

It was inscribed in the UNESCO's Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity in 2010.

Famous Dancers : Jagannath Choudhury, Mousumi Choudhury, Bien Kalindi, Binadhar Kumar, Katik Singh Mura, Baghambar Singh Mura, Upenda Biswal, Banamali Das, Rajendra Pattanayak, Gopal Pasad Dubey etc.

Folk dances

Andhra Pradesh

Dhimsa is a tribal dance performed primarily by Porja caste women in Araku valley, Andhra Pradesh.

Veeranatyam (dance of bravery) is a folk dance of Andhra Pradesh, performed to honor Lord Shiva. It starts with dancers appearing on stage with a plate called "Veerabhadra Pallem" carrying camphor fire.

Kolannalu (stick dance) folk dance is also known as kolkolannalu and commonly known as Kolattam in Telugu (the official language of the state) amongst the people in Andhra Pradesh.

Dappu Nrityam is one of the popular dance forms in Andhra Pradesh and Telangana. This dance form earned its name from the sound produced by a simple percussion instrument, a tambourine-like drum which is called 'Dappu'.

Bhamakalpam is both a dance and a drama. Siddhendra Yogi created this devotional dance form in the 17th century.

Butta Bommalu is popular in the Tanuku region of West Godavari District in Andhra Pradesh.

Tappeta Gullu is a dance that has vigor rhythm and tempo and is performed to invoke the Rain God.

Vilasini Natyam is the dance form of Devadasis of Telugu hence it is also called Devadasi dance.

Lambadi dance is a folk dance of the Banjara community originated in Andhra Pradesh. It is done to impress gods for a good harvest.

Kalapam is a dance-drama with a moral for the audience. It is a mono-play in which there is a main person and another comparatively less significant person.

Gobbi dance is popular in coastal regions of Andhra Pradesh. It is performed during Sankranti festival when houses are cleaned and court yards decorated with 'rangavalli'.

Dandaria dance is a stick dance which is performed by the Gond tribe in the Northern region of Hyderabad district.

Arunachal Pradesh

Ponung is the harvest dance performed by the Adi tribal community of Arunachal Pradesh.

Aji Lhamo is a folk dance form practiced by the Monpa Tribe of Tawang district of Arunachal Pradesh. This dance form is performed during the Losar Festival.

Pasi Kongki is a folk dance of Adi tribe of Arunachal Pradesh that depicts the social work of Pasi. It is performed to the tune of a song sung by the locals, called Aabang.

Tapu dance is a war dance performed by the Adi tribe of Arunachal Pradesh. It takes place during the festival of Unying Aam. It is performed in order to ward off evil spirits from the village.

Wancho dance is performed by the Wancho tribe of Arunachal Pradesh. The Wancho tribes most important festival is known as Oriah.

Buiya is a folk dance of Arunachal Pradesh performed by the Digaru Mishmi tribe. This dance is performed in multiple festivals like Tazampu, Duiya, and Tanuya.

Rikhampada is a dance of Nishi tribe of lower Subansiri District of Arunachal Pradesh.

Popir dance, performed by the Galo tribe of Arunachal Pradesh during Mopi festival.

Shapawng Yawng Manau Poi is an annual festival of the Singpho tribe of

Arunachal Pradesh.

Sangphao tribal dance is performed in Arunachal Pradesh and Nagaland.

Pakhu Itu dance is performed by the Apatani tribe of Arunachal Pradesh.

Assam

Bagurumba is a folk dance of the Bodo community in Assam. It is also called "butterfly dance".

Bhaona is a theatre form. The plays of bhaona are popularly known as Ankiya Nats and their staging is known as bhaona. It is a creation of Mahapurusha Srimanta Sankardeva, written in the early sixteenth century.

Bihu (Rongali bihu, Bohang bihu) dance is an indigenous folk dance from the Indian state of Assam related to the Bihu festival and an important part of Assamese culture.

Deodhani dance, of Bodo-kachari origin, is a folk dance of Assam. It is a solo or group performance (comprises 3 or 4 women). It is associated with the worship of the snake goddess Manasa or Maei/Maroi.

Jhumur is a traditional dance of the tea tribal communities (kulis) of Assam and also in some parts of West Bengal. It is usually performed in the harvest season and festivals.

Bhotal dance is performed in a group of six or seven dancers. It is performed to a very fast beat, known as 'Zhiya Nom'.

Bihar

Bidesiya in Bhojpuri, meaning 'from the foreign land', is a folk theatrical performance of western Bihar. It is based on a drama named Bidesiya written by Bhikhari Thakur.

Chaiti folk dance is performed by men with their bodies smeared with 'ramras'.

Jat-Jatin is a folk dance of Bihar most famous in Mithila and Koshi regions. It is performed on moonlit nights during the monsoon season.

Jhijhiya is a cultural folk dance of Mithila and Bhojpura regions of Bihar and Madhesh province of Nepal. It is usually performed by a group of young women dancers. Portrays offering of prayers to Lord Indra for a good monsoon and a rich harvest. It is performed during the Dussehra festival from the day of

Ghatasthapana to Bijaya Dashami in the Hindu month of Ashwin (September/October). The whole Navaratri nine nights festival is celebrated to worship the three forms of Lord Lakshmi, Parvati, and Saraswati. It has its own types of songs either in Maithili or Bhojpuri language. Women balance the lantern made up of clay on their head and dance.

Jadur is the dance form of the Oraons tribe of Bihar. It is mainly performed during the occasion of Sarhul festival.

Biraha dance, a folk dance of Bihar depicts the anguish of women whose partners are gone from home. This dance is also performed in Jharkhand and Uttar Pradesh. Bidesiya is a derivative of Biraha dance.

Kajari dance welcomes the season of Monsoon and is usually performed in the months of Shavan and Bhadrapad.

Bhojpuri Jhumar dance is popular in Magadh region. It is performed to welcome the spring season.

Magahi Jhumar dance is usually presented in the form of a duet.

Jharni dance is a ritualistic dance performed by the Julaha community during Muharam.

Sohar Khelwana is a dance performed by women to celebrate the birth of a child.

Kishan Nritya is an expression of pride of the farmers of Bihar.

Natua dance begins with an item called the Natua Kachal.

Chhattisgarh

Suwa dance (Parrot dance) is a tribal dance, mainly performed by the Gonds tribe of Chhattisgarh. It is performed exclusively by women on the occasion of Goud's marriage. Dancers keep a parrot in a pot made of bamboo and form a circular shape around it.

Raut Nacha is a ceremonial dance performed mainly by the tribal community of Chhattisgarh. It is performed during the 'Dev udhni ekadashi', after the Diwali festival. It is a dance performed by Yadavas, a caste which are descendants of Krishna.

Karma dance or Karma Naach is a traditional dance of Gond tribals of central and Eastern India annually performed during the karma festival (autumnal festival). It is performed in the

state of Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, Odisha and West Bengal. This folk dance is performed during the worship of the god of fate which is known as Kaam Devta.

Thapati dance is a tribal dance performed by the Korku tribes of Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra. It is performed in the month of Vaishakh. The main instruments of this dance are Dholak and flute.

Saila dance is performed only by boys after the harvest season in the Hindu month of Aghan (November- December). The dance is performed with bamboo sticks.

Panthi dance is a prominent ritual of the Satnami community of Chhattisgarh. It is mainly danced to depict the importance of Durg district to the people. Performed on Maghi Purnima (the birth anniversary of Guru Baba Ghasidas).

Gaur Maria dance is performed in the plateau of Bastar in Chhattisgarh. It is a group dance and both men and women participate enthusiastically in this dance. It is performed on the occasion of marriage.

Bison Horn Maria is a well-known tribal dance performed by the Maria tribe of the Bastar region in Chhattisgarh. The dance gets its name from the distinctive headgear worn by the dancers, which resembles the horns of a wild bison and is decorated with bamboo, peacock feathers, and cowrie shells.

Pandavani dance ballad portrays the account of Pandavas. Recital of tales of Mahabharata is one of its prominent characteristics. The two main styles of the narrations are Vadamati and Kapalik.

Jhirliti dance is performed in a Halloween like ritual. It is played by the kids in the Bastar region of central India.

Gendi dance: Dancers are mounted on two long bamboo. This is a special dance of the Muria tribe of Bastar. It is completely a dance of balance.

Rahas is a modern folk dance of Chhattisgarh and is mainly performed in Dhamtari district. The theme focuses on the immortal love story of Lord Krishna and Radha.

Chaita festival dance is a famous dance of the Gonds of Bastar district. It is

performed after the harvest to thank goddess Annapurna for the harvested crop.

Goa

Dashavatar is the most developed theatre form of the Konkani and Goa regions. The performers personify the ten incarnations of Lord Vishnu-the god of preservation and creativity. The ten incarnations are Matsya (fish), Kurma (tortoise), Varaha (boar), Narsimha (lion-man), Vaman (dwarf), Parashuram, Rama, Krishna (or Balaram), Buddha and Kalki.

Ghode (horse) Modni (dance-like movements) is a warrior dance commemorating the victory of the Ranes, the Maratha rulers of the Sattari taluka in Goa over the Portuguese.

Fugdi dance is mainly the dance of Konkani women. It is performed during festivals like Ganesh Chatuthi, Dhalo festival and Vrata of Goddess Mahalakshmi.

Kunbi dance is a tribal folk dance of the Kunbi community of Goa. Women holding lamps on their heads perform the lamp dance during the Shigmo festival.

Dekhni is a semi-classical dance form of Goa. In Konkani, it means bewitching beauty. It is performed by a group of girls (representing Devadasi) carrying earthen oil lamps in their hands.

Ranmale is a ritualistic and folk theatre form based on mythological stories from the popular Indian epics, the Ramayana, and the Mahabharata. It is performed during the Holi festival which is celebrated as Shigmo (spring festival) in Goa and the Konkani region. It is also practiced in some parts of Maharashtra and Karnataka.

Zemmado is a folk dance of Goa, in which women folk belonging to the Dhangar community imitate the actions of goats.

Trangamel is the folk dance performed during Dussehra and Holi in the state of Goa.

Corridinho is a form of Portuguese dance performed in Goa. It is always a couple dance.

Lamp dance is usually performed during the Shigmo Festival (Goa).

Shigmo dance - The objective of

performing the dance is to celebrate the new crops in the spring season.

Romat dance is a Goan folk dance and procession that is performed in the month of March (at the Singma festival).

Musal is a pounding stick and the dance is performed during harvest time by the people of Chandor the ancient capital of Goa.

Dhalo dance is associated with the fertility of the earth and is a women-only dance.

Goff is a celebration of a bountiful harvest. The songs accompanying the dance are dedicated to Hindu God Lord Krishna.

Romta Mel is a way for Goans to express their thanks to their Gods, accompanied with a serpentine procession of people marching their way to a temple.

Gujarat

Garba (Sanskrit term) dance is performed by women around a centrally lit lamp or a picture or statue of the Goddess Shakti. It is performed during the nine-day festival Navaratri. It is also performed at the Holi spring festival.

Tippani dance uses wooden sticks called "tippanis" to pound the floor rhythmically. Originating from the work-related activities of women in Gujarat, the dance is performed with musical instruments such as dhol and manjira (cymbals), where women stand in two rows and strike the ground in coordination with folk songs.

Shikar Nritya is a traditional tribal dance from the Dhampur region of Gujarat, depicting the customs and traditions of hunting.

Dandiya Raas is the socio-religious featured dance of Navratri evenings in Gujarat. It is also performed in the Marwar region of Rajasthan. It is believed to be performed in memory of Goddess Durga's victory over Mahishasura.

Siddi Dhamal dance form is performed by the men of the Siddi communities in Jafarabad and Jambur and came with them from East Africa.

Rathwa ni gher dance is a tribal dance performed by the Rathwa tribe of Gujarat on the occasion of Holi festival also known as Kavant festival, named after the place where the Holi carnival takes

place. The Gher performances begin on **Dhulendi** (the day of flying coloured dust).

Vinchhudo is a folk dance of Gujaraat. This dance shows strong belief in superstition.

Gheria dance is performed to worship 'Mataji' (Goddess Amba) during Diwali festival. The tribal people of Gujaraat perform the 'Gheria' folk dance dressed in brightly coloured clothes, garlands of marigold flowers and traditional ornaments.

Hudo dance form is mostly performed by the Bhavad or shepherd community especially at the Tarnetar Fair in Suendranagar, Gujarat.

Hallisaka, a group dance, The origin of the Hallisaka dance is traced to the Harivamsa Purana.

Tippani dance form came into existence in Chowad region of Sauashtra in Gujaraat. This dance form is performed in festivals and marriages.

Padhar dance is introduced by the people of the Padhar community (fishermen who live along the banks of Nal Sarovar in the Bhal region).

Dangi Nritya is a tribal dance form native to the Dangs District of Gujarat.

Matukadi dance form is mostly performed by the Rabari and Bhavad communities.

Haryana

Phag is performed in the Hindu month of Phalguna (February–March) to celebrate the colorful festival of Holi in the harvesting season.

Jhumar is a folk dance specially performed by young married women of Haryana. In some parts of the state, it is also known as the 'Hariyanvi Gidda'. Types of Jhumar: Satluj Jhumar, Beas Jhumar, Chenab Jhumar, Multani Jhumar and Jhoomar Taari.

Loor dance is performed around the Holi festival and is very popular in the Bangar and Bagar parts of the region during the month of 'Phalguna' (February/March).

Ratnai dance is a folk dance of Mewati tribes of Mewat region. Mewati (Meo) is an ethnic group from the Mewat region of north-western India which includes the Nuh district in Haryana and parts of adjacent Alwar district and Bhaatpur

district in Rajasthan.

Dhamal dance is famous in the Gurgaon area, which is inhabited by Ahirs. The origin of the dance dates back during the time of the Mahabharata.

Chaupaiyan, which is a devotional dance and is performed by men and women carrying 'manjiras'.

Deepak dance, men and women carrying earthen lamps, express their devotion through dance, which often lasts the whole night.

Been-bansuri dance - During this dance, the dancers use lute and flute to produce music. This dance is famous in the Bangar region of the state.

Ghooa dance is organized on the occasion of the birth of a baby boy.

Chhathi dance is performed on the birth of a male child. Women perform this dance on the sixth day of the birth of the child.

Khoria dance is a collective form of the variety of the Jhumar dance style & steps, exclusively performed by women.

Gugga dance is performed exclusively by men. It is performed in the procession taken out in the memory of saint Gugga.

Himachal Pradesh

Nati dance is traditionally performed in the states of Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand. Several varieties of Nati performed are Kullvi Nati, Mahasuvi Nati, Sirmauri Nati, Kinnauri Nati, Jaunpuri Nati, Seaji Nati, Karsogi Nati, Chuhari Nati, Baada Nati, Bangani Nati.

Dhaman is a folk dance of Himachal Pradesh.

Thoda is a Warrior dance performed by the Rajputs in Himachal Pradesh. It is performed during the Vishu Fair in the month of Chaita and Vaisakh (April-May).

Dangi Dance or Ghuehi dance is performed exclusively by women of Chamba. During the performance one group asks questions while the other replies.

Cholamba dance is performed in Ropa Valley. This dance is performed while coiling a snake.

Dhue dance is also very popular in Lahaul, dances are performed on epics like Ramayana and Mahabharata.

Shan and Shabu are popular dances of Lahaul Valley. These dances are performed in the Gompa in the memory of Buddha.

Laaldi is a popular female folk dance of Himachal Pradesh.

Swaangtegi dance are performed by wearing lion and garden wooden masks on Diwali.

Namgen dance is performed in Himachal Pradesh in the month of September to celebrate the autumn.

Jharkhand

Paika dance is usually performed by Munda tribe to welcome special honoured guests or during religious processions (shobha yatra). This dance form represents the great war of the Munda community against the British. It is also the folk dance of Odisha which is practiced by the Paikas of Oriya army.

Jenana (Janani) Jhumur is a traditional dance of the women performed mainly during the period of cultivation in the rainy season.

Jhika-Dashain is a form of worship dance practiced by the Santhal tribe to train young men of the community in the art of acquiring spiritual powers to dispel the influence of evil spirits.

Santhal dance is a popular folk dance practiced by Santhal tribes in Jharkhand and West Bengal. It is performed in groups. It is very similar to the bamboo folk dance of Assam and Mizoram.

Baao dance is a celebration of the Oraon community thriving in the state of Jharkhand. It is one of the largest groups dwelling in the hilly region of Hazaribagh Goomla. The Oraon community is also known as Kurukh.

Mundari dance is a famous folk dance of the Munda community of Jharkhand and Orissa. It is a women centric dance.

Phagua is a dance form popular among the tribes residing in Jharkhand and the adjoining state Bihar. It is performed during Holi – the spring festival.

Birhor dance is a tribal folk dance from Jharkhand. The Birhors are a tribal /Adivasi forest people, traditionally nomadic living in states of Jharkhand, Orissa, Chhattisgarh and West Bengal.

Kadsa dance is a dance style performed

carrying a 'Kalashá (eathen pot). This is a female dominated dance.

Mardani Jhumur is performed by the men of the Nagpuri community and Southern cultures dance after the harvest.

Jhitka and Danga dances are performed by both men and women to celebrate different feudal traditions.

Lahasuya is a Nagpuri folk dance of the Chota Nagpur Plateau region of Jharkhand.

Ghoda Naach dance performed only by men. The wooden puppet is the main prop used.

Sarhul is a traditional dance which is performed by the Oraon tribe in Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh and West Bengal.

Karnataka

Huttari dance (Kodagu dance) is one of the most spirited dances of Karnataka. Different forms of this dance are Bolak-aat, Ummatt-aat, and Komb - aat.

Bolak-aat dance is performed by Kodava men dressed in all black with an oil lamp in the open field.

'Ummatt-aat is a folk dance form performed in Coorg. This dance is performed by the Kodava women.

Komb-aat, is a devotional dance which is carried out in a temple by the Kodava men. They carry horns of a deer that indicate the horns of the "Krishna muga" (a deer of a Kodava epic) while playing tunes on wind instruments and drums.

Yakshagana is a traditional folk dance form popular in coastal Karnataka districts and some parts of Kerala.

Veeragase / Veerabhadrana kunitha is one of the dances demonstrated in the Dasara procession held in Mysore, during the hindu months of Shavana (July - August) and Kathika (October - November).

Kamsale (Beesu Kamsale) is a unique folk art performed by the devotees of God Mahadeshwara. Kamsale also refers to a brass made musical instrument.

Bhootada Kola dance is highly stylized and held in honor of the local deities worshiped by the Tulu speaking population. It has influenced Yakshagana folk theatre.

Bayalata is an open air theatre form. It features stories from Indian epic poetry and the Puranas rendered as dance and drama.

Sadal Kekai is a folk dance of Nagaland performed by the Kuki tribe.

Goavara Kunitha is often a tradition of a dance of Kuruba Gowdas who are the worshippers of Lord Mailana Longa. Bhootha Aradhane represents the worship of the Devil.

Gaarudi Gombe basically means magical puppet in Karnataka. It is especially performed during festivals and processions to ward off evils.

Pata Kunitha is a group dance performed by 10 to 15 persons together.

Dollu Kunitha dance performed primarily by men of the shepherd community called the Kuruba.

Naga mandala dance is usually performed by male dancers, called Vaidyas. Within the dance, they dress up as Nagakannikas or as female snakes.

Suggi is a dance performed at the time of harvesting by the Halakki Vokkaliga tribe.

Aati Kalanja is a ritualistic folk dance performed by the 'Nalke' Community.

Kerala

Velakali is a traditional martial dance performed by the men of the Nair community of Kerala.

Mangalamkali is a dance ritual followed by the Mavilan tribes of North Kerala.

Koodiyattam (Kutiyattam) is a traditional performing art form in the state of Kerala. It is traditionally performed in temple theatres known as Koothambalam. It was officially recognised by UNESCO as a Masterpiece of the Oral and Intangible Heritage of Humanity in May 2001.

Magomkali is a ritual folk art dance of the Syrian Christians of Kottayam and Thrissur districts in Kerala.

Mudiyettu, a dance drama is a village ritual performed by members of the Maar and Kuruppu communities in Thrissur, Ernakulam, Kottayam and Idukki districts of Kerala. In 2010 it was inscribed in the UNESCO's

Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity.

Thullal is a solo satiric dance belonging to the state of Kerala. There are three versions of this art form - Sheethankan Thullal, Parayan Thullal and Ottan Thullal.

Theyyam (Kaliyattom) is a ritualistic folk dance originated in North Kerala. The ritual used to be performed at the sacred groves and shrines. The musical instruments used in this magnanimous art form are Chenda, Kurumkuzhal, Elathalam, and Vekkuchenda. Varieties of Theyyams are Raktha Chamundi, Muchilottu, Kari Chamundi, Bhagavathi, Gulikan, Wayanadu Kulaven, and Pottan.

Pulikali (Leopard Dance) is a recreational folk art performed at the annual harvest festival Onam.

Elelakkandi is a well-known dance form of the tribal group called Irulas of Attappady in Palakkad District.

Kalaripayattu (Kalari) is an Indian martial art that originated in modern-day Kerala. It is mentioned in the Vadakkan Pattukal, a collection of ballads written about the Chekavar of the Malabar region of Kerala.

Kummattikali (Kummatti) is a colourful mask dance prevalent in Kerala and parts of South Malabar. It is performed during the Onam festival.

Padayani literally means "row of warriors" is a dance form belonging to Kerala. Performed in honour of "Bhadakali" (i.e. an avatar of Lord Shiva).

Thiruvathirakali (Kaikottikali) is performed on the auspicious day of Thiruvathira, the birthday of Lord Shiva. It falls in the Malayalam month of Dhanu (December - January).

Chakyar Koothu is a solo performance in which the performer dresses up as a snake.

Chavittu Natakam, is believed that the art form flourished at Kodungalloor in Kerala with the spread of Christianity.

Chavittukali is a folk dance performed by Ullada, Ooli, Cherumar and Kanakkaar communities.

Kakkarissi Natakam is a folk art form popular in Central Travancore.

Kanyarkali is a folk dance ritual performed in Bhagavati temples and Vettakorumakan Temple of Palakkad district.

Arjuna Nritham (Mayilpeeli Thookam), is a ritual art of Kerala performed in the Bhagavati temples of south Kerala, mainly at Kollam, Alappuzha and Kottayam.

Ezhamathukali, a folk art form closely related with the ancient Sanghakali, is also known as Ezhamadukali, Ezhamuthipuppadd etc.

Alamikali was a popular regional art form in Kasargod, performed by Alamis', soldiers of Tipu's army.

Vedanpaattu is a traditional folk art form performed in the Malayalam month of Karkidakam (June/July) in remote parts of Kerala.

Onathar is a traditional folk art form performed during Onam season in Kannur and adjoining areas.

Ivarkali (Aivarnatakam, Thattinmelkali, Kannilkuthikali, Pandavarkali) is played by Ikkudikammalar people belonging to the Vishwakarma community

Kathaprasangam or the art of storytelling performance is a popular art form which blends the tradition of music and speech together.

Oppana is a song and dance performance popular among the Muslims of Malabar

Madhya Pradesh

Maach is a form of folk theatre from the Malwa region of Madhya Pradesh. It is performed around the Indian festival of Holi.

Ahiai is a popular dance form of the Bharia tribe.

Bhadam (Bhangam dance) is mainly performed by the Bharia tribe of Madhya Pradesh on the occasion of marriage.

Sahariya dance is a famous dance performed by the Saharia community of Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan. It is performed during the month of Holi to the beats of the dhol, nagari and matki.

Bhagoriya is a well known dance of the Bhils, a large tribe of the Jhabua district in Madhya Pradesh.

Grida dance is performed to celebrate the "harvesting of crops". It has three phases: Sela, Selalarki and Selabhadoni.

Matki dance is mostly performed in the Malwa region by nomadic tribes.

Phulpati dance is performed in Malwa region of India (western Madhya Pradesh and south eastern Rajasthan) by unmarried girls.

Jawaa dance is a popular folk dance of Madhya Pradesh. It is mainly famous in the Bundelkhand region among the peasant community

Lehangri is a popular folk dance of the Banjar and Kanjar tribe of the Bhopal commissary of Madhya Pradesh and is performed during the blossoming monsoon period.

Baedi is an important folk dance of the Gwalior district. Starting from Diwali, the dance is performed till the day of 'Kaithik Purnima'.

Bilma dance is performed by the Gond and Baiga tribes during the festival of Dussehra.

Chatkon dance is done by the Korku tribe. It is in the Chinndwa and Betul districts.

Kanga dance is performed by the Dhobi caste in Bundelkhand.

Gocho dance is performed by the Gond tribals.

Reena dance is performed by the Baiga and Gond tribal women during the festival of Diwali.

Atari dance is the dance of the Bhumiya and Baiga tribes of Baghelkhand region.

Muria dance is performed near the Ghotul.

Saria dance is a traditional folk dance from Madhya Pradesh, India. It is performed during main festivals to celebrate the monsoon and agricultural season. The dance is accompanied by Rai songs.

Badhai is a popular folk dance of the Bundelkhand region of Madhya Pradesh. It is performed on joyful occasions such as the birth of a child, marriages, and festivals like Diwali, where people dance while offering "Badhai" (congratulations) to one another.

Maharashtra

Lavani dance is generally performed by Dhangars or shepherds living in the Solapur district of Maharashtra. The traditional percussion instrument used to accompany it is Dholki.

Lezim is a folk dance where the dancers carry a small musical instrument with jingling cymbals called the 'Lezim'. The first Lezim performance to an international audience was presented at the 9th Asian Games in the year 1982 at Delhi.

Dhangari Gaja dance (Dhangar dance) is performed by the shepherd community known as Dhangars during the Navratri festival.

Tamasha dance form has been believed to be derived from the ancient form of Sanskrit drama - the 'Pahsana' and the 'Bhanda'. Kolhati and Mahar groups are associated with the performance of Tamasha. It is a traditional Maathi folk-theatre form commonly performed in villages during the festival of Shimga (Holi), and the Kolhati community has been historically associated with Tamasha troupes.

Vaghya Muali dance originated in Maharashtra, associated with Lord Khandoba.

'**Pvadas**' folk dance is presented in the Maathi ballad form. This dance form describes the events in the life of the founder of the Maatha Empire, Shri Chhatapati Shivaji Maharaj.

Koli dance is a popular folk dance of the Maharashtra and Goa states of India. It was created by the Kolis tribe of Mumbai. It is performed by traditionally a fishing community

Dindi dance is performed on Ekadashi in Katik month of the Hindu calendar.

Nakata dance is performed by the fisher community of Maharashtra.

Gafa dance is performed by a group of boys.

Kala dance is a form of folk dance that describes the mood of Lord Krishna. It is a symbol of fertility.

Songi Mukhawate is derived from the two lion masks worn by two dancers who represent Naasimha, an aspect of Lord Vishnu. The dance celebrates the victory of truth over falsehood.

Dholacha Nach is performed by the Warli tribe in the Thane district of Maharashtra.

Manipur

Shim Lam dance (Fly dance) is the traditional folk dance of the Rongmei community

Luivat Pheizak is one of the most popular dances of the Tangkhul Naga community of Manipur

Nupa dance is a variation of Pung Cholom. It is also known as Cymbal dance or Katal Cholom. It is accompanied by an ancient classical drum called "Pung" in Manipuri. It is performed by only male dancers.

Rakhal Nritta is a part of Raas Leela. Manipuri boys are performing a dance at Under the Kadam tree.

Katabenlu Laam (Bangle Dance) is known for its intricate footwork and rhythmic movements.

Mao Naga dance is performed by the Mao Naga community during the annual harvesting and seed-sowing festivals (Chikhuni).

Rao-Sa Jagoi dance is part of the traditional Kanglei Haraoba.

Kabui dance is performed by the Kabui community during the Gang - Ngai festival.

Raas is a highly developed dance drama depicting Lord Krishna's union with his female followers, the gopis, and especially his consort-devotee Radha. The Raas Leela was first started as a dance form by Maharaja Bhagya Chandra.

Thabal chongba is traditionally performed during the festival of Yaoshang.

Lai Haraoba dance enacts the 'Creation of the Universe', which was initially a part of the Lai Haraoba festival.

Thang-Ta (martial art) symbolises an old and outstanding Manipur culture. It demonstrates the remarkable combat style of the Thang (sword) and the Ta (spear).

Lhou Sha is a battle dance that is performed at every clash between two villages.

Meghalaya

Laho dance is performed by the Jaintia tribe of Meghalaya. It is performed during the Behdienkhlam festival. It is also known as the Chiphah Dance. When the Harp tribe of Meghalaya performs this dance, it is known as Wangla dance.

Nongkrem dance festival is celebrated during Autumn at Smit, the cultural centre of the Khasi Hills. A five day long religious festival of the Khasis, Ka Romblang Nongkrem dance is popularly known as Nongkrem dance.

Behdienkhlam is the main dance of the "Jaintias" festival held every July in Jowai, Jaintia Hills.

Chad Suka, a popular traditional dance festival of Meghalaya, is celebrated as a Sowing festival. It is celebrated every year by the Pnar people of Jaintia Hills.

Shad Suk Mynsiem is an annual spring dance that celebrates the harvest and planting season. It is known as the 'Dance of Peaceful Heats', is an annual spring festival celebrated by the Khasi community of Meghalaya.

Dorsekata dance festival is also a dance in which the women try to take the turbans off their male partners during the dance.

Mizoram

Cheaw folk dance performed with bamboo sticks. On the occasion of 'Buza Aih', or bumper harvest, an individual family performs Cheraw dance.

Khuallam dance is usually performed during the ceremony of 'Khuangchawi'. Literally, the terms 'Khual' and 'lam' mean guest and dance respectively. Khuallam literally means 'Dance of the Guests'.

Chailam dance is mainly practiced during the festival of Chapchar kut and is regarded as one of the most significant festivals of Mizo people.

Solakia dance is prevalent in Mizoram. 'So' means the severed head of an enemy 'La' means dance and 'Kia' refers to that which has been done with better understanding and knowledge.

Chawnglaizawn is a popular folk dance of one of the Mizo communities known as Pawi.

Tianglam is performed throughout the state using music of Puma Zai.

Zangtalam dance is mainly performed by the 'Paihte' tribe.

Nagaland

Zeliang dance is performed by the Zeliangrong Naga tribe found in the hilly terrain of Mount Barail in Nagaland.

Changai dance is performed by the Chang tribe during the Naknyulum festival, which lasts for three days.

Chang Lo dance (Sua la) is performed by the Chang tribe. It is performed in a three day festival known to be 'Boanglem', marking the beginning of the harvest season in the state.

Aaluyattu is performed by the Konyak tribe.

Udoho dance is a traditional war dance of the Angami Naga tribe.

Rangma folk dance performed by the Naga people. It is usually a part of the Ngada festival. It depicts war culture and men dressed up like warriors.

Leshalaptu is a folk dance performed by the women of Nagaland.

Shankai and Moyashai are the victory dances performed by the Lotha tribe of Nagaland.

Rukhyo Sharu dance is performed by the Lotha Naga tribe.

Langnyu-Khiamtsangshe dance is a traditional folk dance performed by the Khiamnungan Naga tribe of Nagaland during two of their most important festivals i.e. Miu and Tsokum, which are co-related to each other.

Akok-Khi is a dance form performed by the Sangtam tribe during the Mongmong festival.

Changsang dance is a traditional folk dance performed by the Chang Naga Tribe during Naknyulum festival in the month of July

Monyu Asho dance is performed by the Phom Nagas during the Phom Monyu festival which is the biggest festival of the Phom Naga tribe. It is celebrated in the month of April.

Khupielilie dance is a traditional folk dance performed by womenfolk of the Pochury Naga Tribe of Nagaland.

Kukui Pheb dance is a traditional folk dance performed by Chakesang Nagas.

Kulu-Tsen is the name of a traditional Naga folk dance of the Yimkhiong tribe.

Nokinteler Tsungsang dance is a Naga traditional dance form of the Ao Naga tribe.